

Art of illusion

Check out the workshop on 3D modelling

1993

The year GPS became fully operational



GPS software for the Blackberry (Moving maps, Google Maps, Blackberry Maps)

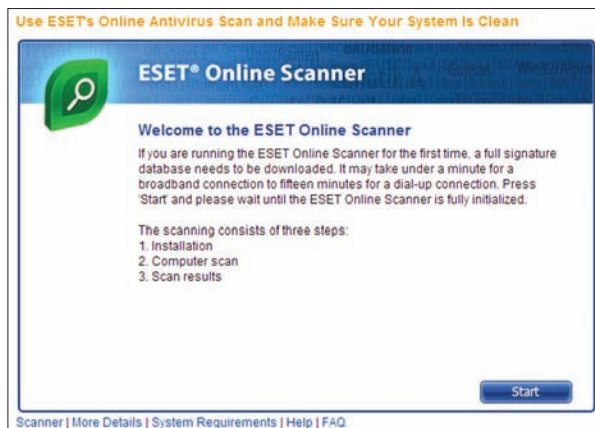
(<http://aerotools.hoshis.org/index.html>)

Q Folders can't be accessed

I am using a branded desktop and I have a problem accessing my drives. The drives don't open by double-clicking as normal. I have to open them by going through the folder options present in the menu bar. Is it due to a virus? I have been scanning my computer regularly, but I can't find any viruses. How can I get rid of it?

Aryendu Pattnaik

A It is a virus and you should try some other antivirus program. We recommend trying Kaspersky and NOD32. There are also some free online scanners that are worth trying. Bitdefender's online scanner (<http://www.bitdefender.com/scan8/ie.html>),

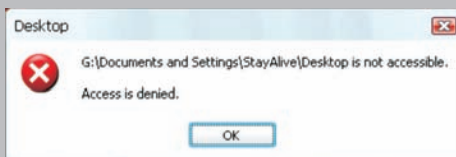


ESET Online Scanner is one of the free online virus scanners

Q Access denied to my own desktop!

I use a dual-OS setup with Windows Vista Ultimate and Microsoft Windows XP. When I was using Vista, I opened the Windows folder in the XP installation and it prompted me for the security check permissions. Now when I log on to XP, an error occurs every time saying access to the desktop is denied. I tried refreshing the desktop, but each time the same error appears. When I start the machine (for the first time only), the screen pauses nearly a minute to get to the logon screen every time.

Is this problem only occurring because of the two operating systems? When I use a single operating system, it works fine. I have the minimum number of startup programs and I have also modified the start-up using Bootvis. I have also cleared up all dust from



ESET Online Scanner (<http://www.eset.com/onlinescan/>), Trend Micro's Housecall (<http://housecall.trendmicro.com/>) and Kaspersky Lab Scanner (<http://www.kaspersky.com/virusscanner>) are some of the ones available. Be sure to disable your existing antivirus before you use any other scanner.

Q Computer slow to boot

My problem is that my PC takes a lot of time to start (around two minutes). Another question is that I am planning to buy a ZOTAC GeForce 9800 GTX Amp! or something similar, but I want to know if I have to buy a new SMPS. I currently use a 450-W power supply. Will my card will be compatible with my motherboard or not? I also want to change my OS to Windows 7 (from XP)? Should I do it?

My computer specifications are:

Motherboard: Gigabyte 945GCM-S2L (S-series)

Processor: Core 2 Duo E7300 (2.67 GHz)

RAM: 2 GB DDR2

Graphics: Currently Onboard

HDD: 250 GB SATA

OS: Windows XP

Gappu

A It's not clear why your system is taking too long to boot up. Try defragging the drive and if you have two sticks of memory, remove one and try booting. Try the same steps with the other module.

The GeForce 9800GTX needs a PCI-Express x16 slot, which the Intel 945 board has. Hence, there shouldn't be any problem upgrading. Running a GeForce 9800GTX on a 450-W power supply might not be a good option, unless it's a very good power supply. A 500-W or higher power supply is recommended.

Although Windows 7 seems to be liked by many, it's a time-limited beta. Therefore, it's a good idea to have XP running along with Windows 7. Your system and the memory is more than sufficient for it to run.

Q Boot problem, HDD not detected

I bought an assembled PC last September. It worked very well for a month or so, but then I started to face some problems. My system would stop responding and everything would black out. Then, a message would show up "Failed to create user login dialogue" with a "Security failure" error in the centre.

On pressing OK, the system restarts. On start up, it fails to detect any HDD. Also, there

my cabinet and checked the power supply but of no use. I have recently upgraded my machine.

The system configuration:

Processor: Pentium Dual-Core 2 GHz

Motherboard: Gigabyte 945GCM

Memory: 2 GB

A The problems you are facing with accessing partitions and data in the Windows folder is because of the permissions set for each operating system. Preferably, use the exact login information for both the operating systems. Access for the folder might have been set to a particular account on XP. Therefore, when you use a different user account on Vista, you are prompted for authentication information. The fix now can be to create a new user account, preferably a common username and password to both operating systems. The excess time taken to access the login window might also have to do with the access restrictions set. The Access Denied errors might be because you changed the rights and permissions for the Windows XP folders.